DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 10

BI developer

Profession 10 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A BI developer builds the reporting layer for a business: data connections, models, dashboards and scheduled reports, usually with a BI tool such as Power BI or Tableau.

What professionals do every day

Connects sources, designs models, builds reports, sets refresh schedules and access, and supports business users with changes.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Leaders need the same numbers in every meeting. A BI developer delivers reports that refresh and agree with each other.

- Reports that disagree.
- Refreshes that fail without anyone knowing.
- Users asking for the same change repeatedly.

Skills you need

- Data modelling for reporting.
- Power BI or Tableau.
- Refresh and access control.
- Testing reports against source data.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Power BI Desktop	Dashboards	Free	Power BI Pro and Premium plans (verify)	powerbi.microsoft.com/desktop/
Tableau Public	Charts	Free	Paid desktop	public.tableau.com
Looker Studio	Dashboards	Free	Free	lookerstudio.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Build one report from a single source.
Intermediate	Set up a scheduled refresh (where the tool allows).
Advanced	Test one total against the source.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Monthly management pack.
- **Intermediate:** Sales dashboard for regions.
- **Advanced:** Finance report with access control.

Client-ready portfolio project

A management pack for a fictional firm: one model, four report pages, refresh notes and a reconciliation of totals to the source.

Worked example

Worked example. Before publishing, the total revenue on the dashboard is checked against the SQL total: 11,100 for the sample data.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Reconcile the dashboard to the source

Business problem: A dashboard total must match the source before the leadership team uses it.

Steps

1. Compute the source total with SQL.
2. Compare it with the dashboard total.
3. Investigate any difference.
4. Record the check in the handover.

Expected output: A matching total and a check record.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

SQL

```
SELECT channel, SUM(amount) AS revenue
FROM orders
GROUP BY channel
ORDER BY revenue DESC;
```

The channel totals sum to 11,100. The dashboard total must show the same figure; a difference means a filter or a join is wrong.

Common mistakes

- Publishing without reconciliation.
- Hard-coded numbers in the dashboard.
- No owner for data refresh.
- Access given to everyone by default.

Freelancing opportunities

- BI builds for small and mid-size firms.
- Reporting maintenance contracts.
- Briefs for 'BI developer', 'Power BI', 'Tableau dashboard'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Microsoft Power BI documentation

Part of **Master Freelancing: Data Analytics and Data Science**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.